



EU Artificial Intelligence Act

What is the EU Artificial Intelligence Act?

The EU AI Act is a European regulation on artificial intelligence (AI) – the first comprehensive regulation on AI by a major regulator anywhere in the world.



Understanding the AI Act is essential for organisations looking to innovate with AI while complying with both legal and ethical standards.

As AI's capabilities and business benefits have grown, so have its complexities and risks, driving governments worldwide to address how best to protect the public while not stifling innovation.

As of August 2024, The AI Act is now in force. With tiered implementation dates ranging from six months to over a year out, organisations still have time to understand what exactly compliance under the act entails.

What does the EU AI Act actually do?

The Regulation lays down:

1. harmonised rules for the placing on the market, the putting into service, and the use of AI systems in the EU
2. prohibitions of certain AI practices
3. specific requirements for high-risk AI systems and obligations for operators of such systems
4. harmonised transparency rules for certain AI systems
5. harmonised rules for the placing on the market of general-purpose AI models
6. rules on market monitoring, market surveillance, governance and enforcement
7. measures to support innovation, with a particular focus on SMEs, including startups.

Who does the Act apply to?

The new regulation applies to;

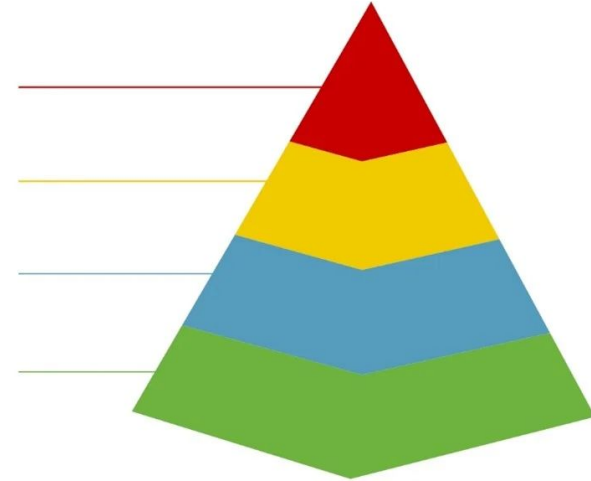
1. Providers placing on the market or putting into service AI systems or general-purpose AI models in the EU, irrespective of whether those providers are established or located within the EU or in a third country
2. Deployers of AI systems that have their place of establishment or are located within the EU
3. Providers and Deployers of AI systems that have their place of establishment or are located in a third country, where the output produced by the AI system is used in the EU
4. Importers and Distributors of AI systems
5. Product Manufacturers placing on the market or putting into service an AI system together with their product and under their own name or trademark
6. Authorised Representatives of providers, which are not established in the EU
7. Affected Persons that are located in the EU

The Act's Risk-Based Regulatory Approach

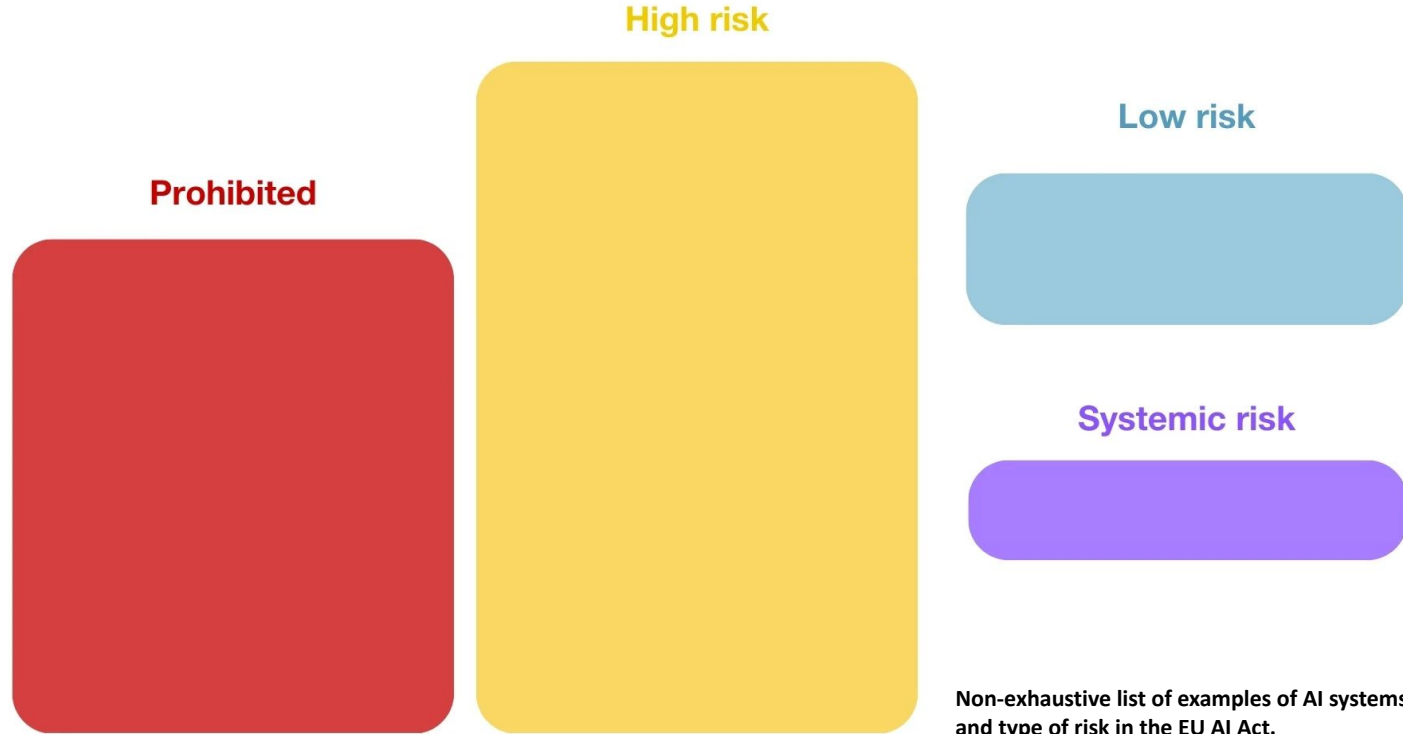
The Act distinguishes AI systems based on their risk levels to human rights, health, safety, and societal impacts. It outright bans AI systems considered to pose unacceptable risks, while high-risk AI systems can be deployed under stringent conditions. The Act focuses on high-risk applications, ensuring that critical areas such as healthcare, law enforcement, and employment are subject to stringent requirements, promoting trust and safety in their development and deployment in the EU market.

Given their system risk profile, the Act subjects all general-purpose AI (GPAI) models to transparency requirements, with high-impact GPAI models facing even more rigorous obligations.

- **PROHIBITED AI SYSTEMS**
Prohibited
- **HIGH RISK AI SYSTEMS**
Must undergo a conformity assessment
- **LOW RISK AI SYSTEMS**
Must adhere to transparency requirements
- **NO RISK AI SYSTEMS**
No obligations



Examples of AI Systems



Group Task!

In groups of 4 to 5 students you must investigate an allocated area of The EU AI Act.

Create a short presentation that summarises the teaches the class about the main points of your allocated area of the Act.

Use any presentation format (or mixture of formats) you wish.



Group Task!

- A. Obligations on providers (developers) of High-Risk AI systems → **Rooms: 1 & 2**
- B. Obligations on providers (developers) of General Purpose AI (GPAI) → **Rooms: 3 & 4**
- C. Enforcement (Governance) and Penalties → **Rooms: 5 & 6**
- D. Measures in Support of Innovation → **Rooms: 7 & 8**

Useful Resources

<https://artificialintelligenceact.eu>

<https://enterprise.gov.ie/en/what-we-do/innovation-research-development/artificial-intelligence/eu-ai-act/>